

AP EUROPEAN HISTORY · THE UNIVERSAL STUDY GUIDE

Targeting a 3, 4, or 5 — every concept tagged for your tier

Tier badges: [3] foundational · [4] adds for 4+ · [5] adds for 5

Targeting a 4 → study [3] AND [4] items. Targeting a 5 → study all three tiers.

PAGE 1 | MATH OF 3/4/5 · 9 UNITS · 4 ERAS · 5 THEMES (SP-ICE)

About this exam. AP European History covers ~1450 to the present — Renaissance through today. Like APUSH, it has **MCQ + SAQ + DBQ + LEQ** format. The signature challenge: **CHANGE OVER TIME** across 500+ years. The exam rewards students who can connect Renaissance humanism → Enlightenment → French Revolution → Liberalism → World Wars → EU as a single thread.

THE MATH OF YOUR TARGET

Target	MCQ (55q, 40%)	SAQ (3q, 20%)	DBQ (1q, 25%)	LEQ (1q, 15%)	Tier
3 (PASS)	~28-32	~5-6/9	~3/7	~3/6	[3]
4	~36-40	~7/9	~4-5/7	~4/6	[3] + [4]
5	~44-48	~8-9/9	~6-7/7	~5-6/6	All

Time pressure: 55 MCQ in 55 min, 3 SAQ in 40 min, 1 DBQ in 60 min (with 15 min reading), 1 LEQ in 40 min. **The DBQ + LEQ together = 40% of your score** — write fast and structured.

THE 9 UNITS — by exam weight

#	Unit	Weight	Era / focus
1	Renaissance & Exploration	10–15%	1450–1648 · Italian → Northern Renaissance, Age of Exploration
2	Age of Reformation	10–15%	1517–1648 · Luther, Calvin, religious wars, Catholic Reformation
3	Absolutism & Constitutionalism	10–15%	1648–1815 · Louis XIV, Glorious Rev., Sci. Rev.
4	Scientific, Philosophical, Political Developments	10–15%	Enlightenment, French Rev., Napoleon
5	Conflict, Crisis & Reaction in Late 18th Century	10–15%	Revolutions of 1789, 1830, 1848; Concert of Europe
6	Industrialization & Its Effects	10–15%	1750s onward · Industrial Rev., 19th-c. "isms"
7	19th-Century Perspectives & Political Developments	10–15%	Nationalism, unification of Italy/Germany, imperialism
8	20th-Century Global Conflicts	10–15%	1914–1945 · WWI, interwar, totalitarianism, WWII, Holocaust
9	Cold War & Contemporary Europe	10–15%	1945–present · Cold War, decolonization, EU, post-1989

All units are equally weighted (~10-15%). No unit dominates — broad mastery beats deep dives.

THE 5 THEMES — "SP-ICE" [3]/[4]

Theme	What it captures
S — Social	Class, gender, family, demographics, popular culture, race
P — Political	States, governments, revolutions, citizenship, nationalism, war
I — Interaction with Environment	Disease, climate, technology, exploration, industrialization's environmental toll
C — Cultural & Intellectual	Religion, philosophy, art, science, literature, ideologies ("isms")
E — Economic	Trade, capitalism, mercantilism, industrialization, globalization

KEY INSIGHT [5] On every FRQ, name the theme(s) you're using. "This represents a **POLITICAL** change driven by **CULTURAL** forces (Enlightenment ideas)..." Naming themes earns context credit and structures your essay.

PAGE 2 | UNITS 1–2: RENAISSANCE · EXPLORATION · REFORMATION

Italian Renaissance (~1350–1550) [3]/[4]

- **Humanism [3]** = revival of classical Greek/Roman texts; emphasis on human potential, civic engagement, secular concerns. **Petrarch** = "father of humanism."
- **Civic humanism [4]** = ideal of educated citizen serving the state. **Castiglione's _The Courtier_** = manual for Renaissance gentleman.
- **Machiavelli's _The Prince_ (1513) [3]/[4]** = political realism. "Better feared than loved." Separation of ethics from politics.
- **Italian art [3]/[4]**: Michelangelo, Leonardo da Vinci, Raphael, Donatello. **Patronage** by Medici (Florence), papacy. **Linear perspective** + chiaroscuro.
- **[5] Renaissance women**: limited roles. **Christine de Pizan** challenged misogyny. **Isabella d'Este** = elite patron. Most women excluded from humanism.

Northern Renaissance & Christian Humanism [3]/[4]

- **Erasmus [3]** = leading Christian humanist. *In Praise of Folly* (1511) — satirized Church corruption. "Erasmus laid the egg that Luther hatched."
- **Thomas More [4]** = *Utopia* (1516). **Northern art**: Dürer, van Eyck — oil paint, realistic detail.
- **Printing press [3]** (Gutenberg, ~1450) = exploded literacy, spread of ideas. Without it, no Reformation as we know it.

Age of Exploration (~1450–1600) [3]/[4]

- **Motives [3]**: "Gold, God, Glory" — wealth (spices, bullion), spread Christianity, royal prestige.
- **Portugal [3]** led: Henry the Navigator, Vasco da Gama (India), Bartolomeu Dias (Cape of Good Hope).
- **Spain [3]**: Columbus 1492, Cortés (Aztecs), Pizarro (Inca). **Treaty of Tordesillas (1494)** = pope splits New World between Spain/Portugal.
- **Columbian Exchange [3]/[4]** = transfer of plants, animals, diseases between Old and New Worlds. **Disease devastated Native populations** (~90% mortality).
- **[4] Commercial Revolution**: joint-stock companies, banking, **price revolution** from American silver. **Mercantilism [3]/[4]** = wealth = bullion; favorable balance of trade; colonies serve mother country.

The Reformation (1517–1648) [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Luther's 95 Theses (1517) [3]** = attacked indulgences. **Justification by faith alone** (sola fide), **scripture alone** (sola scriptura), priesthood of all believers.
- **Calvin (Geneva) [3]/[4]** = predestination, theocratic government. Spread to Scotland (Knox/Presbyterians), France (Huguenots), Netherlands, England.
- **Henry VIII (England) [3]** = Act of Supremacy (1534) — broke from Rome over annulment, made King head of Church of England (Anglican).
- **Catholic Reformation [4]** = **Council of Trent (1545–63)** reaffirmed Catholic doctrine, fixed abuses. **Jesuits** (Loyola) = education + missions. **Inquisition + Index of Forbidden Books**.
- **Religious wars [4]/[5]**: French Wars of Religion (Edict of Nantes 1598), Dutch Revolt against Spain, **Thirty Years' War (1618–48)** = devastated Germany. **Peace of Westphalia (1648) [4]** = states choose religion; modern state sovereignty begins.

KEY INSIGHT [4] Westphalia (1648) is a TURNING POINT. Marks: end of religion as basis for European war + birth of the modern sovereign-state system + decline of universal Church/Empire authority. Cite it on any FRQ about state-building or religion's political role.

PAGE 3 | UNITS 3–4: ABSOLUTISM · CONSTITUTIONALISM · SCI. REVOLUTION

Absolutism — France: Louis XIV (1643–1715) [3]/[4]

- "L'état, c'est moi" [3] = "I am the state." **Divine right** monarchy.
- **Versailles** [3] = palace as instrument of control. Forced nobles to live at court → tied them to royal favor, away from regional power bases.
- **Colbert** [4] = Louis's finance minister. Mercantilist policies — built French industry, navy, colonies.
- **Revoked Edict of Nantes (1685)** [4] = expelled Huguenots → economic blow (skilled workers fled to England, Netherlands, Brandenburg).
- **Wars** [4]: War of Spanish Succession (1701–14) — **Treaty of Utrecht (1713)** prevented French-Spanish union; established **balance of power** principle.

Other Absolutisms [3]/[4]/[5]

State	Key features
Prussia [4]	Hohenzollerns. Frederick William the Great Elector built army. Frederick II (the Great) = Enlightened despot, Silesia from Austria.
Russia [3]/[4]	Peter the Great (1682–1725) = westernization, St. Petersburg, Table of Ranks. Catherine the Great (1762–96) = Enlightened veneer, partitions of Poland, expanded south to Black Sea.
Austria [4]	Habsburgs. Multinational empire (Germans, Magyars, Slavs). Maria Theresa + son Joseph II (Enlightened despot, abolished serfdom briefly).
Spain [4]/[5]	Decline after Philip II. Lost Netherlands, weakened by inflation, expulsion of Moriscos.

Constitutionalism — England [3]/[4]

- **Tudor → Stuart conflict** [3]: James I + Charles I clashed with Parliament over taxes, religion.
- **English Civil War (1642–49)** [3]/[4]: Parliament (Roundheads) vs. King (Cavaliers). **Charles I executed (1649)**. **Cromwell** ruled as Lord Protector.
- **Restoration (1660)** [3]/[4]: Charles II restored. **Glorious Revolution (1688)** [3]/[4] = James II out, William & Mary in. **English Bill of Rights (1689)** = limited monarchy, parliamentary supremacy.
- **Dutch Republic** [4] = constitutional alternative. Trading wealth (VOC), religious toleration, decentralized government, golden age of art (Rembrandt, Vermeer).

Scientific Revolution (~1543–1687) [3]/[4]

Figure	Contribution
Copernicus [3]	1543 <i>De Revolutionibus</i> — heliocentric model. Challenged Ptolemaic geocentrism + Church.
Galileo [3]	Telescope, Jovian moons → confirmed heliocentrism. Inquisition trial (1633) — forced to recant.
Kepler [4]	Elliptical orbits, three laws of planetary motion.
Newton [3]/[4]	<i>Principia</i> (1687) — laws of motion + universal gravitation. The synthesis unifying Copernicus, Galileo, Kepler.
Bacon [3]/[4]	Inductive method — observation + experiment. "Knowledge is power."
Descartes [3]/[4]	Deductive method — "I think, therefore I am" (cogito). Mind/body dualism.

Enlightenment (~1715–1789) [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Locke** [3]/[4]: tabula rasa, natural rights (life, liberty, property), social contract → consent of governed → right of revolution.
- **Voltaire** [3]: religious toleration, freedom of speech. "Crush the infamous thing" (clerical abuse).
- **Montesquieu** [3]/[4]: *Spirit of the Laws* — separation of powers, checks & balances.
- **Rousseau** [3]/[4]: *Social Contract* — "general will," popular sovereignty. Democratic + collectivist.
- **Adam Smith** [4]: *Wealth of Nations* (1776) = free markets, invisible hand, division of labor. Critique of mercantilism.
- **Wollstonecraft** [4]/[5]: *Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792) — gender equality, education for women.
- **Salons** [4] = women-led gatherings (Mme Geoffrin) where Enlightenment ideas circulated.

PAGE 4 | UNITS 4–5: FRENCH REVOLUTION · NAPOLEON · 1815–1848**French Revolution Causes [3]/[4]**

- **Three estates [3]:** 1st (clergy ~0.5%), 2nd (nobles ~1.5%), 3rd (everyone else ~98%). Tax-exempt 1st and 2nd.
- **Financial crisis [3]/[4]:** war debts (American Rev.), bankrupt court, attempted reforms blocked by nobles.
- **Estates General called 1789 [3]** for first time since 1614. **Tennis Court Oath** = 3rd Estate becomes National Assembly.
- **Bastille (July 14, 1789) [3]** = symbolic start of revolution.

French Revolution — phases [3]/[4]/[5]

Phase	Years	What happened
Liberal	1789-91	Declaration of Rights of Man , abolish feudalism, Civil Constitution of Clergy , constitutional monarchy.
Radical	1792-94	Republic declared , Louis XVI executed (1793). Reign of Terror (Robespierre, Committee of Public Safety) — 40,000+ killed. Levée en masse = mass conscription.
Reaction	1794-99	Thermidorian Reaction — Robespierre executed. Directory (1795-99) = corrupt, weak.
Napoleon	1799-1815	Coup of 18 Brumaire (1799) . Consul → Emperor (1804). Napoleonic Code, Concordat with Pope, conquests, defeat at Waterloo (1815).

Napoleon's Impact [3]/[4]

- **Napoleonic Code [3]/[4]** = legal equality, property rights, secular law. Spread across Europe → lasting legacy.
- **Spread of Revolutionary ideas [4]** = nationalism, liberalism, end of feudalism in conquered areas.
- **[4] BUT also** = imperial domination provoked nationalist BACKLASH (Spain, Germany, Russia).
- **Continental System [4]** = economic blockade of Britain → backfired; pushed Russia to break with Napoleon.
- **Russian campaign (1812) [3]/[4]** = ~600,000 in, ~100,000 out. Beginning of end.

Congress of Vienna (1814–15) & Concert of Europe [3]/[4]

- **Architects [3]:** Metternich (Austria), Castlereagh (Britain), Talleyrand (France), Tsar Alexander I (Russia).
- **Principles [4]:** **legitimacy** (restore old dynasties), **balance of power** (no France domination redux), **compensation** (winners get land), **concert/cooperation**.
- **Holy Alliance [4]** (Russia, Austria, Prussia) = suppress liberal/national revolts.

KEY INSIGHT [4] Vienna mostly succeeded. No general European war for 99 years (1815–1914) — the longest peace since Roman times. But it suppressed liberalism + nationalism, building pressure that exploded in 1848.

Revolutions of 1830 & 1848 [3]/[4]

- **1830 [3]:** France replaces Charles X with "citizen king" Louis Philippe. Belgium independence from Netherlands. Failed Polish revolt.
- **1848 — "Springtime of Peoples" [3]/[4]:** revolts across France (Second Republic), Austria (Metternich resigns), Italy, Germany (Frankfurt Assembly), Hungary.
- **Outcomes [4]:** ALL FAILED short-term. Conservative restoration. **BUT:** serfdom abolished in Austria, French Second Republic born, ideas of nationalism + liberalism unstoppable long-term.
- **Marx + Engels: _Communist Manifesto_ (1848) [3]/[4]** = published amid revolutions. Class struggle, proletariat overthrows bourgeoisie.

PAGE 5 | UNIT 6: INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION · 19th-CENTURY "ISMS"

Industrial Revolution — Britain First (~1750–1850) [3]/[4]

- **Why Britain first [3]/[4]:** coal + iron, navigable rivers, agricultural revolution → labor surplus, capital from trade/colonies, stable government, Enlightenment scientific culture.
- **Textile breakthroughs [4]:** spinning jenny (Hargreaves), water frame (Arkwright), power loom (Cartwright).
- **Steam engine (Watt) [3]/[4]** = unhitched factories from rivers. **Railroads** transformed transport, markets, military mobilization.

Social Effects of Industrialization [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Urbanization [3]** = peasants → cities. Manchester, Birmingham, Lyon, Essen explode.
- **Working-class conditions [3]/[4]:** 14-hour days, child labor, unsafe factories, slums, cholera.
- **Middle class rise [3]/[4]:** factory owners, professionals, clerks. "Cult of domesticity" — separate spheres for men (work) and women (home).
- **[4] Reform:** British Factory Acts (1833+), Reform Act of 1832 (expanded male suffrage), Chartism (failed but seeded change), labor unions.
- **[5] Second Industrial Revolution (1870+):** electricity, chemicals, steel, internal combustion. Germany + US overtake Britain.

THE 19TH-CENTURY "ISMS" — your master matrix

"Ism"	Core idea
Liberalism [3]	Constitutional government, individual rights, free trade, property-based suffrage. Middle-class. Mill, Bentham.
Conservatism [3]	Order, tradition, monarchy, established Church. Burke. Metternich. Resists change.
Nationalism [3]/[4]	Cultural/ethnic group should have its own state. Started liberal (1848), turned exclusionary by late 19th c.
Socialism [3]/[4]	Collective ownership of means of production. Utopian (Owen, Fourier, Saint-Simon) → Marxist (scientific socialism).
Marxism [3]/[4]	Class struggle, proletariat revolution overthrows bourgeoisie, classless society. <i>Communist Manifesto</i> (1848), <i>Das Kapital</i> (1867).
Romanticism [3]/[4]	Reaction against Enlightenment rationalism — emotion, nature, individuality. Wordsworth, Goethe, Beethoven, Delacroix.
Realism [4]	Mid-19th c. — depict life as is. Dickens, Balzac, Courbet.
Anarchism [4]/[5]	Abolish state. Bakunin, Proudhon. Inspired political assassinations late 19th c.
Zionism [4]/[5]	Theodor Herzl (1896) — Jewish state in response to European antisemitism.
Social Darwinism [4]/[5]	Misapplied evolution to human societies. "Survival of fittest" used to justify imperialism, racism, laissez-faire.
Feminism [4]/[5]	Wollstonecraft → Seneca Falls (1848 US) → Pankhursts (UK suffragettes, 1900s).

KEY INSIGHT [4] FRQ tactic. When asked "how did 19th-c. Europeans respond to X?" — answer with at least 2 "isms" in tension. Liberals wanted X for one reason, conservatives opposed it; nationalists supported it for different reasons. Multi-ism analysis = strong argument.

PAGE 6 | UNIT 7: UNIFICATIONS · IMPERIALISM · ROAD TO WWI

Italian Unification (1859–1871) [3]/[4]

- **Cavour (Piedmont-Sardinia) [3]/[4]** = Realpolitik. Allied with France (Napoleon III) to expel Austria from northern Italy.
- **Garibaldi & Red Shirts [3]** = conquered Sicily + Naples, handed to King Victor Emmanuel II.
- **1871 [3]** = Rome added; unification complete. "**Italy made; now we must make Italians**" — north/south + class divisions persisted.

German Unification (1864–1871) [3]/[4]

- **Bismarck [3]/[4]** (Prussian chancellor, 1862) = master of Realpolitik. "**Blood and iron**" speech.
- **Three wars [3]/[4]**: (1) **Danish War (1864)** vs Denmark; (2) **Austro-Prussian War (1866)** = Prussia kicks Austria out of German affairs; (3) **Franco-Prussian War (1870–71)** = unifies German states against France.
- **1871 [3]**: Wilhelm I crowned **Kaiser at Versailles** (humiliation of France). German Empire (2nd Reich) born.
- **Bismarck's domestic [4]/[5]**: **Kulturkampf** vs Catholics (failed); **anti-socialist laws + first welfare state** (state pensions, sickness insurance) to undercut socialists.

Other 19th-c. Political Developments [4]

- **Britain [4]**: Reform Acts (1832, 1867, 1884) gradually expanded suffrage. Ireland question persisted.
- **France [4]**: Napoleon III's Second Empire (1852–70) → Third Republic (1870–1940). **Dreyfus Affair (1894–1906)** revealed antisemitism + civilian-military tensions.
- **Russia [4]**: **Emancipation of serfs (1861)** under Alexander II. Slow industrialization. **1905 Revolution** → October Manifesto, Duma (weak).
- **Austria-Hungary [4]**: **Compromise of 1867 (Ausgleich)** = dual monarchy. Nationality problem (12+ groups) unsolved.

New Imperialism (~1880–1914) [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Scramble for Africa [3]/[4]**: **Berlin Conference (1884–85)** divided Africa among Europeans. By 1914, only Ethiopia + Liberia were independent.
- **Asia [3]/[4]**: Britain in India (Raj), French Indochina, Dutch East Indies, Russia in Central Asia. China = "spheres of influence," Boxer Rebellion (1900).
- **Justifications [3]/[4]**: economic (raw materials, markets), strategic (coaling stations), nationalist prestige, "**white man's burden**" / **civilizing mission** (Kipling), Social Darwinism.
- **Critics [4]/[5]**: Hobson, Lenin (*Imperialism: Highest Stage of Capitalism*).
- **[5] Resistance**: Sepoy Mutiny (1857), Maji Maji (1905), Herero genocide (1904–08), Boxer Rebellion.

Road to WWI [3]/[4]

M-A-I-N causes:

Militarism	= arms race, glorification of military
Alliances	= Triple Entente (Brit/Fra/Rus) vs Triple Alliance (Ger/Aus/Ita)
Imperialism	= colonial rivalries, fear of being "left behind"
Nationalism	= especially Balkans + ethnic tensions in Austria-Hungary

TRIGGER: Archduke Franz Ferdinand assassinated, Sarajevo, 28 June 1914
 Austria → Serbia, Russia mobilizes, Germany declares on Russia + France,
 invades neutral Belgium → Britain enters. War in 6 weeks.

PAGE 7 | UNIT 8: WWI · RUSSIAN REVOLUTION · INTERWAR · WWII

World War I (1914–18) [3]/[4]

- **Trench warfare [3]** on Western Front. Mud, machine guns, gas, ~10 million military dead.
- **Total war [3]/[4]** = entire economy mobilized. Women into factories. Rationing. **Government powers expand massively.**
- **Eastern Front [4]**: Russia vs Germany/Austria. Russia collapses 1917 → **Treaty of Brest-Litovsk (1918)** with Germany, huge territorial loss.
- **US enters 1917 [3]** after unrestricted submarine warfare. Tipped the balance.
- **Treaty of Versailles (1919) [3]/[4]**: Germany — war guilt clause (Article 231), reparations, lost colonies + territory, army limited to 100,000. **Wilson's 14 Points** + League of Nations (US never joined).

Russian Revolution (1917) [3]/[4]

- **February Rev. [3]**: Tsar Nicholas II abdicates → Provisional Government (liberal, kept Russia in war = fatal mistake).
- **October Rev. [3]/[4]**: **Lenin's Bolsheviks** seize power. "Peace, Land, Bread." Brest-Litovsk pulls Russia from war.
- **Civil War (1918-21) [4]**: Reds vs Whites. **War communism** → famine, terror.
- **NEP (1921) [4]** = limited capitalism to recover. **Stalin (1928)** ends NEP → 5-Year Plans, **forced collectivization** (5-7 million dead, **Holodomor** in Ukraine), **Great Purges (1936-38)**, gulag.

Interwar — Weimar, Fascism, Nazism [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Weimar Germany [3]/[4]** = constitutional but unstable. **Hyperinflation (1923)** → currency worthless. Stresemann recovery 1924-29.
- **Great Depression (1929+) [3]/[4]** = global. Devastated Germany — 6 million unemployed by 1932.
- **Mussolini's Italy [3]** = March on Rome (1922). **Fascism [3]/[4]**: ultranationalist, militaristic, anti-communist, anti-liberal, corporatist economy, cult of leader. Lateran Treaty (1929) with Church.
- **Hitler/Nazism [3]/[4]**: appointed Chancellor Jan 1933. Reichstag Fire → Enabling Act → dictatorship. **Nuremberg Laws (1935)** strip Jewish citizenship. **Kristallnacht (1938)**.
- **Spanish Civil War (1936-39) [4]/[5]**: Franco's Nationalists (Germany/Italy aid) vs Republicans (USSR aid). Preview of WWII.
- **Appeasement [3]/[4]**: Munich (1938) — Chamberlain gives Hitler the Sudetenland. "Peace for our time" = catastrophe. **Nazi-Soviet Pact (Aug 1939)** stunned the world.

World War II (1939–45) [3]/[4]

- **Sept 1939**: Germany invades Poland. UK + France declare war.
- **Blitzkrieg [3]** = lightning war. France falls in 6 weeks (1940). **Battle of Britain (1940)** — RAF holds.
- **Operation Barbarossa (June 1941) [3]/[4]** = Germany invades USSR. Eastern Front = bulk of fighting + casualties.
- **Pearl Harbor (Dec 1941) [3]** brings US in. Stalingrad (1942-43) turning point. D-Day (June 1944). VE Day May 1945; VJ Day Aug 1945 (atomic bombs).
- **Holocaust [3]/[4]**: ~6 million Jews systematically murdered, plus Roma, Slavs, disabled, LGBTQ, political prisoners. **Wannsee Conference (1942)** = "Final Solution" formalized. Auschwitz-Birkenau, Treblinka, Sobibor.

KEY INSIGHT [4]/[5] On Holocaust FRQs: connect to (a) long-tradition European antisemitism, (b) Nazi racial ideology + Social Darwinism, (c) total-war state's bureaucratic capacity, (d) collaboration AND resistance across occupied countries. Avoid "Hitler's evil" alone — explain mechanisms.

PAGE 8 | UNIT 9: COLD WAR · DECOLONIZATION · EU · POST-1989

Origins of the Cold War (1945–53) [3]/[4]

- **Yalta + Potsdam (1945) [3]**: Big Three carved up Europe. Stalin took Eastern Europe.
- **Iron Curtain [3]** (Churchill 1946). **Truman Doctrine (1947) [3]/[4]** = contain communism (Greece, Turkey).
- **Marshall Plan (1948) [3]/[4]** = US economic aid to rebuild Western Europe + bind it to US. USSR rejected → COMECON for East.
- **Berlin Blockade/Airlift (1948-49) [3]/[4]** = first Cold War crisis. **Two Germanys (1949)**.
- **NATO (1949) [3]** vs **Warsaw Pact (1955) [3]**.

Cold War Crises & Détente [3]/[4]

- **Hungarian Revolution (1956) [4]** crushed by Soviet tanks. **Berlin Wall (1961) [3]**. **Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)** — closest to nuclear war.
- **Prague Spring (1968) [4]** — Dubček's "socialism with a human face," crushed. **Brezhnev Doctrine** = USSR will intervene.
- **Détente (1970s) [4]**: SALT I + II, Helsinki Accords (1975) — recognized borders + human rights.
- **Reagan + Thatcher [4]/[5]**: renewed military buildup early 1980s. Strategic Defense Initiative ("Star Wars").

Decolonization (~1947–1975) [3]/[4]

- **India (1947) [3]** = first major. Partition into India + Pakistan. ~1 million dead in violence.
- **Africa [3]/[4]**: Ghana (1957) first sub-Saharan; ~1960 "Year of Africa" — 17 newly independent. **Algerian War (1954-62)** brutal. **Suez Crisis (1956)** ended British/French global power claims.
- **[5] Causes of decolonization**: WWII bankrupted colonial powers; nationalist movements; superpower opposition to old empires; UN principle of self-determination.

Western European Integration [3]/[4]/[5]

1951	European Coal & Steel Community (ECSC) — France, W.Germany, Italy, BeNeLux
1957	Treaty of Rome → European Economic Community (EEC)
1973	UK, Ireland, Denmark join
1986	Single European Act → single market
1992	Maastricht Treaty → European Union (EU)
1999	Euro introduced (cash 2002). Not all members adopted.
2004+	Eastern European states join after Cold War
2016	Brexit referendum. UK formally exits 2020.

End of Cold War & After (1985+) [3]/[4]

- **Gorbachev [3]/[4]** (1985): **glasnost** (openness) + **perestroika** (restructuring). Aimed to reform Soviet system, accelerated collapse.
- **1989 Revolutions [3]/[4]**: Solidarity in Poland (Lech Wałęsa), Hungary, **Berlin Wall falls Nov 9, 1989**, Czechoslovakia (Velvet Revolution), Romania (Ceaușescu executed).
- **USSR dissolves Dec 1991 [3]**. Russia + 14 other states emerge.
- **Yugoslavia disintegrates [3]/[4]**: wars 1991-99. **Bosnia genocide** (Srebrenica 1995). NATO intervention in Kosovo (1999).
- **Post-1989 issues [4]/[5]**: rapid market transitions in East, EU enlargement, immigration, 2008 financial crisis, populism, Russia-Ukraine.

PAGE 9 | MASTER TIMELINE · TURNING POINTS · PEOPLE TO KNOW**THE 12 BIGGEST DATES IN AP EURO [3]/[4]**

Year	Event + why it's a turning point
1450	Gutenberg printing press — exam start point. Information revolution makes Reformation possible.
1517	Luther's 95 Theses — fractures Western Christianity.
1648	Peace of Westphalia — modern sovereign-state system; religion no longer dictates war.
1687	Newton's <i>Principia</i> — Scientific Revolution synthesis.
1789	French Revolution starts — modern political ideologies (liberal/conservative/radical) born.
1815	Congress of Vienna — 99 years of relative peace; conservative restoration.
1848	Year of Revolutions + <i>Communist Manifesto</i> — old order shaken; ideologies clarified.
1871	German + Italian unification complete — power balance reshaped, sets stage for WWI.
1914	WWI begins — "long 19th century" ends; Europe destroys its global supremacy.
1917	Russian Revolution — communist regime, 70-year ideological alternative born.
1945	WWII ends — European empires bankrupt, US/USSR superpowers, Holocaust transforms moral discourse.
1989	Berlin Wall falls — Cold War ends, Europe "whole and free" project.

PEOPLE TO KNOW BY ROLE — quick recall [3]/[4]/[5]

Role	Who
Renaissance humanists	Petrarch, Erasmus, More, Machiavelli (political), Castiglione
Reformers	Luther, Calvin, Zwingli, Henry VIII, John Knox, Loyola (Counter)
Scientific Revolution	Copernicus, Galileo, Kepler, Newton, Bacon, Descartes
Absolute monarchs	Louis XIV, Peter the Great, Catherine the Great, Frederick II, Maria Theresa, Joseph II
Constitutional	Cromwell, William & Mary, Locke
Enlightenment	Voltaire, Montesquieu, Rousseau, Smith, Wollstonecraft, Diderot
French Rev.	Robespierre, Marat, Danton, Marie Antoinette, Lafayette, Napoleon
1815-48	Metternich, Mazzini, Garibaldi (early), Marx, Engels
Unification & 19c	Cavour, Garibaldi, Victor Emmanuel II, Bismarck, Disraeli, Gladstone, Bismarck, Tsar Alexander II
Late 19c-WWI	Wilhelm II, Franz Joseph, Nicholas II, Lenin, Trotsky, Wilson
Interwar	Mussolini, Hitler, Stalin, Chamberlain, Franco
WWII + Cold War	Churchill, FDR, de Gaulle, Adenauer, Truman, Khrushchev, Brezhnev, Tito, Reagan, Thatcher, Gorbachev, Kohl, Walesa, Havel

CHANGE OVER TIME — exam favorite [4]/[5]

LEQ + DBQ love asking "how did X change from period A to period B?" Master these CONTINUITIES + CHANGES:

- **Religion's political role:** dominant 1450 → contested 1517-1648 → secularized after 1648 → marginal by 1900.
- **Status of women:** limited Renaissance → some Enlightenment salons → legal reform 19th c. (Married Women's Property) → suffrage 1900s-1920s → workplace gains post-1945 → 2nd-wave 1960s+.
- **State power:** limited 1500 → absolutist 1650-1800 → constitutional/national 1815-1914 → total-war 1914-45 → welfare state OR totalitarian 1945+.
- **Europe's global position:** emerging 1500 → dominant 1815-1914 → wrecks itself in WWs → loses empires → integrates as EU.

PAGE 10 | FRQ DECODER · SCORE LADDER · TIER CHECKLISTS

THE 4 FRQ TYPES — points + structure [3]/[4]

Type	Points	Quick recipe
SAQ (3 q × 3 pt)	9	No thesis needed. A/B/C: each part = 1 sentence claim + 1 specific evidence + 1 sentence elaboration. Tight, factual.
DBQ (1 q)	7	Thesis (1) + Contextualization (1) + Evidence: 4 docs (1) → 6 docs supporting argument (3) + 1 outside evidence (1) + Sourcing/HIPP for 2 docs (1) + Complex understanding (1).
LEQ (1 q, choice of 3)	6	Thesis (1) + Context (1) + 2 specific evidence (1) → use it for argument (1) + Reasoning structure (1) + Complex understanding (1).

DBQ — the 7-point breakdown [3]/[4]/[5]

- **Thesis [3]** = defensible claim; cannot just restate prompt. Place in intro OR conclusion.
- **Context [3]** = 2-3 sentences setting up the broader era BEFORE/around the prompt window.
- **Document use [3]/[4]**: USE 4 docs minimally → use 6 to SUPPORT thesis (not just describe). Quote/paraphrase + name the document.
- **Outside evidence [3]/[4]** = something specific NOT in any document, used to support thesis.
- **Sourcing (HIPP) [4]** = for ≥2 docs, explain HOW one of: Historical situation, Intended audience, Point of view, Purpose affects what the document says.
- **Complex understanding [5]** = nuance, multiple causes, counter-evidence, modification of thesis. Hardest point — practice essays specifically for this.

THE SCORE LADDER

For a 3 (Pass)	For a 4	For a 5
MCQ: 28-32 / 55	MCQ: 36-40 / 55	MCQ: 44-48 / 55
SAQ: 5-6/9 (one solid sentence per part)	SAQ: 7/9 (specific evidence each part)	SAQ: 8-9/9 (every part nailed)
DBQ: thesis + 4 docs + context.	DBQ: thesis + 6 docs + outside ev. + 2 sourcing.	DBQ: all 7 incl. complex understanding.
LEQ: thesis + 2 evidence + simple structure.	LEQ: thesis + reasoning + multiple specifics.	LEQ: complex understanding (counter-claim, nuance).
Know 9 unit timelines + key turning points.	Add: 19th-c. "isms" matrix + 12 big dates.	Add: change-over-time threads + historiographical nuance.

TIER-SPECIFIC TEST-DAY CHECKLISTS

For a 3 — focus only on these:

- ✓ MCQ: 28+ correct.
- ✓ SAQ: 1 sentence claim + 1 specific fact + 1 elaboration per part — every time.
- ✓ Know the 12 biggest dates and what each represents.
- ✓ DBQ: at least thesis + use 4 docs + simple context.

For a 4 — add these on top:

- ✓ MCQ: 36+ correct.
- ✓ DBQ uses 6+ docs to ARGUE (not just describe), with 1 outside evidence + 2 sourcing (HIPP).
- ✓ Cite at least 2 "isms" in 19th-c. responses.
- ✓ Name turning points by date (1648, 1815, 1848, 1871, 1914, 1945, 1989).

For a 5 — add these on top:

- ✓ MCQ: 44+ correct.
- ✓ Complex understanding on DBQ + LEQ (counter-claim, multiple causes, nuance, qualification).
- ✓ Discuss continuities AND changes across periods (change-over-time).
- ✓ Acknowledge competing historiographical interpretations when relevant.
- ✓ Connect SP-ICE themes to one another in essays.

THE ONE THING THAT MATTERS MOST [3][4][5]: ARGUE WITH SPECIFIC EVIDENCE. AP Euro rewards specificity. "Industrialization changed society" earns nothing. "In Manchester between 1820 and 1840, the working-class life expectancy fell to 17 while the middle class enjoyed reformed Anglican prayer books — a SOCIAL divide visible in CULTURAL practice" earns full credit. Always: NAME a person, place, date, OR document. Vague generalities lose; specific names + dates + thinkers win.

If you do nothing else: master the 12 turning points + the "isms" matrix, and load every essay with named specifics. That's the AP Euro formula.

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